Don Hopkins

Chief Architect at Pantomime Corporation

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Summary

Chief Architect for the networked Pantomime™ software platform, which turns any mobile device into a 3D paddle that lets users reach into AR/VR worlds and enjoy a realistic (or fantastic) response.

Part of the core team of four programmers who developed The Sims. (Best selling computer game of all time).

Worked with Will Wright at several companies including Maxis on The Sims, at EA on The Sims and SimCity, at his start-ups including Stupid Fun Club, MediaGraph and Syntertainment on robot brains, toys, speech, GPS, reality TV, storytelling, mobile games and secret stuff.

Developed Project Alive-PD for NutritionQuest, a nutritional and physical analysis, goal coaching and tracking, and behavior intervention program, for preventing diabetes and improving nutrition and physical activity.

Developed Micropolis (open source SimCity) for OLPC, desktop and web, as well as other open source projects including pie menus and a cellular automata machine simulator.

Worked at TomTom in Amsterdam on bittorrent content distribution, user created content sharing, user interface programming, and internationalization.

Worked for Laszlo Systems on video components and Laszlo Mail: http://www.laszlomail.com

Developed ConnectedTV, a personalized TV program guide and universal remote control for the Palm.

Ported SimCity Classic to Unix for DUX Software. Designed and developed a networked multi-player version of SimCityNet. Persuaded EA to make SimCity open source.

Worked at Interval Research on visual programming and multimedia authoring tools.

Worked at Kaleida Labs on ScriptX, and object oriented multimedia programming languages.

Worked at the Turing Institute on the HyperLook UI builder.

Worked at Sun Microsystems on The NeWS Toolkit, an Open Look GUI written in PostScript for NeWS.

Experience

Chief Architect at Pantomime Corporation

2014 - Present (2 years)

I've been developing the networked Pantomime™ platform that lets mobile and stationary devices share augmented reality and VR worlds.

Research Simulation Engineer at Syntertainment

October 2013 - 2014 (1 year)

Syntertainment lives at the intersection of entertainment and reality. Founded by game industry legend Will Wright, members of Stupid Fun Club and more, we are a small team of talented designers, technologists, and entrepreneurs who have previously created genre-defining works like SimCity, The Sims, Spore and Google Earth. http://www.syntertainment.com/

Software Developer at Block Dietary Data Systems

September 2005 - 2014 (9 years)

Project "Alive!": designed, developed and administered Project "Alive!", an email based nutritional and physical activity behavior intervention program. Worked with Kaiser Permanente, supported by Centers for Disease Control. Ran an empirical study to evaluate the efficacy of Project "Alive!". Integrated Project Alive! with Facebook, supporting shared goals, gift certificates, educational discounts, PayPay integration, FBML, OpenLaszlo components.

NutritionQuest Online Food Frequency Questionnaire and Analysis System: Re-architected, overhauled and extended the NutritionQuest Online Food Frequency Questionnaire and Analysis System, rewriting and enhancing the OpenLaszlo online questionnaire user interface, renovating old PHP code, rewriting old C and SAS analysis code in PHP and Python, designing and implementing a new open-ended extensible analysis system, and using spreadsheets, XML, PHP and MySQL to configure the analysis system.

Hyper Research Programmer at Stupid Fun Club

August 2009 - September 2013 (4 years 2 months)

Will Wright imagination implementation. Dot connecting. Box outing. Design interaction. Fun prototyping. Zeitgeist reification. Entertaining tank thoughts. Pseudo-scientific visualization. Playing field exploration. Mediating entertainment boundary crossings. Computing ubiquitous mobile pervasions.

According to S.F.C. CEO Will Wright, "The Stupid Fun Club is Stupid ... and Fun ... but not really a Club. We eventually want to help robots take over the world ... but for right now we're just having stupid fun."

Senior Software Developer, Dynamic Content and Publishing at TomTom

July 2007 - August 2009 (2 years 2 months)

Worked at TomTom in Amsterdam. Developed TomTom Home with Mozilla xulrunner, XPCOM, XUL, JavaScript. Researched and developed BitTorrent XPCOM plug-in for xulrunner with libtorrent, BitTorrent DNA. Designed and developed a user created content sharing system with Java. Worked on WebKit browser based user interface and Mongoose web server running on embedded TomTom devices.

Contractor at Broadband Mechanics

November 2005 - July 2007 (1 year 9 months)

PeopleAggregator Screen Scraper. Developed an open-ended Python web page scraper and web service client for hot-syncing text and multimedia data with social networking services. Supports MySpace, Facebook, AIM, Flickr, YouTube, Google Videos and other social networking and web services.

Contractor at Laszlo Systems

March 2005 - July 2007 (2 years 5 months)

Worked with Sarah Allan to develop the OpenLaszlo streaming video and webcam components, tests and demos, and the Laszlo Mail application.

OpenLaszlo Video Components. Enabled OpenLaszlo developers to easily plug together applications with streaming video, webcams, etc. Developed low level video streaming and webcam components, and high level gui components, tests and demos.

The YouTube player demo is currently featured on the OpenLazlo Home Page, and described on my web page with links to its source code, at OpenLaszlo YouTube Player Demo and Source Code. Integrated YouTube player with Laszlo WebTop.

Laszlo Mail. Purpose: Rich web email reader application. Developed in OpenLaszlo by Laszlo Systems. Programmed Email folder outline editor drag and drop user interface, and client/server XML protocol. Developed cross browser email attachment upload component.

Technically reviewed an upcoming book about OpenLaszlo application development and user interface programming.

Contractor at Kennedy Labs

June 2001 - July 2007 (6 years 2 months)

Worked with Sherman Kennedy on challenging multimedia contracting projects.

Big World Terrain Importer. Purpose: Program the "Big World" MMPORG editing tool in Python and C++ to import terrain geographical data, and draw roads and features on the map. Extended the Python interface to the C++ terrain editing tools, and wrote Python scripts to import data and drive the editing tools from data under program control. Technologies: BigWorld MMPORG, C++, Python.

Video Mad Libs. Purpose: Real time digital video blue screen compositing. Composite video camera source over DVD source. Record results to DVD. Matrox video graphics hardware drivers. Programming DirectShow filter graphs. Technologies: C++, Matrox Digisuite SDK, DirectShow, ActiveX, MFC, Filter Graph Editor.

Hand Held Devices. Embedded StrongARM programming and debugging. Technologies: C, StrongARM Assembly, Dragonball Processor, SD Card Hardware, Metrowerks Codewarrior.

Architect, UI Designer, Programmer, System Administrator at ConnectedMedia

May 2001 - July 2007 (6 years 3 months)

Working with David Levitt for ConnectedMedia, developing ConnectedTV, a subscription service with software that turns your Palm into a personalized TV guide, integrated with a universal remote control. ConnectedTV categorizes shows, filters unwanted programs, and remembers your favorite shows. It features pie menus, so you can easily browse the guide in one hand without a stylus, stroke the name of any show to read the description or change the channel, and send IR remote control commands to consumer electronic equipment.

Contractor at Electronic Arts

March 2000 - July 2007 (7 years 5 months)

Porting SimCity to the OLPC: Cleaning up the code, setting up Fedora Core in VmWare for development and testing, assisting with the QA process, fixing bugs, and adapting it to the OLPC hardware and software environment, in preparation for relicensing SimCity under the GPL.

Developing, documenting, distributing, supporting and upgrading The Sims Transmogrifier, a tool for cloning and modifying Sims objects. Enables players to customize their game. Spawned a cult cottage industry of web sites catering to Sims players. Built higher level object cataloging and personalization tools. (Like RugOMatic, ShowNTell, SimFreaks catalog, etc.)

Maintained The Sims character animation exporter plug-in to 3D Studio Max. Updated the character animation plug-in I developed in C++ and MaxScript, to support the new version of 3D Studio Max.

Ported The Sims from Windows to Linux and optimized it to run as a "headless" server without graphics and sound, to support The Sims Online.

Contractor at John Gilmore, Entrepreneur and Civil Libertarian

June 1989 - July 2007 (18 years 2 months)

John Gilmore contracted me to develop various open source projects.

Ported SimCity to OLPC. Adaped SimCity to the OLPC hardware, Linux, Python, and Sugar gui, renovating SimCity source code to prepare for EA to relicense it under the GPL.

Worked on OLPC eBook Reader ("Read Activity"), supporting eBook mode, game controller inputs, power conservation, accessibility.

Developed a Python module for plugging together, configuring and testing Gnu Radio signal processing modules. Used SWIG to integrate template based C++ code with Python. Enable Python scripting, configuration, testing and driving of Gnu Radio digital signal processing software components.

Developed and documented the PSIBER Space Deck for NeWS, a visual PostScript programming and debugging interface for the NeWS window system.

Contractor at ReQuest

July 2006 - August 2006 (2 months)

Performed a code review and quality evaluation of OpenLaszlo source for ReQuest's touch screen media player home automation user interface. Answered questions about OpenLaszlo and Flash player optimization.

Contractor at Backstop Media

January 2006 - May 2006 (5 months)

Wrote a three part tutorial series for IBM's DeveloperWorks web site, about OpenLaszlo and PHP: Spice Up PHP Applications with OpenLaszlo. Technologies: PHP. OpenLaszlo. XML. JavaScript. ReST. SQL. Derby.

Contractor at Bartlett Net Services

September 2005 - April 2006 (8 months)

Worked with Mark Bartlett to develop and maintain Zope web sites, Plone content management systems, Versant coporate community web site, and develop the SOXPro content management system.

Versant Web Site. Corporate presence and developer community web site. Product and company information. User registration. Developer community support discussion groups and wiki. Documentation and white paper download. Software download and license key generation. Sales lead notification. Employee blogging. User sign-up, management and user database integration. Customer activity and download activity reporting. Internationalization. WYSIWYG content editing. Staging.

SOXPro. SOX (Sarbanes/Oxley) Compliance Content Management System. Business practice documentation. Compliance verification. Auditing. Procedure flowcharting. Graphical flowcharts and swimlane diagrams. WYSIWYG editing. Typed linking and cross referencing. Keyword tagging and searching. Task assignment and management.

Contractor at Technorati

February 2004 - July 2004 (6 months)

Technorati Internet Explorer Toolbar. Purpose: An internet explorer toolbar that lets you search Technorati for reference to the current web page. Post a blog entry about the current web page. WYSIWYG editor for blog postings. Linking with vote-for, vote-against, and other typed relationships. Generic blog-tool plug-in interface with support for Blogger API, MetaWeblog API, Movable Type API, Atom API, Technorati API. XOXO and attention.xml support. Implemented with IE browser in toolbar, so most code is written in JavaScript, with OLE automation interfaces for special features implemented in C++. XML/JavaScript template system for dynamically generating data driven DHTML user interfaces.

Contractor at Vivere Systems

September 2003 - January 2004 (5 months)

Network Firewall Monitor. Purpose: Remote network firewall management and monitoring interface. Remove device management. Graphical device status displays and network activity log graphs. Interactive AJAX SVG/XML based interface. Fallback to server side rendering with Batik for non-SVG browsers and phones.

Research Programmer at Stupid Fun Club

April 2002 - August 2003 (1 year 5 months)

Worked with Will Wright, developed robot brain and control system in Python, running on experimental social robots created by Stupid Fun Club. Developed ideas for toys and games, implemented proof of concept prototypes for patent applications, concept demos, and TV show pilots. Helped develop and perform hidden camera "One Minute Movie" robot reality shows.

Developed telerobotic interface for remotely controlling robot behavior, speech synthesis, facial animation, personality simulation, etc. Used for human/computer interaction research, improvisational performance, and reality TV show pilots.

Developed hidden camera reality TV spots, written by Will Wright and produced by NBC, about a Broken Robot (Empathy), and a Robot Waiter (Servitude).

Developed simulation of talking toys communicating via IR signals with coded conversational protocol.

Expressive Speech Synthesizer and Editor. Synthesize, play, display and edit inflected synthetic speech.

Contractor at Charles River Media

November 2001 - February 2002 (4 months)

Wrote a chapter about pie menus for the book Game Programming Gems 3, titled "Natural Selection: The Evolution of Pie Menus".

Contractor at Noggin

April 2001 - September 2001 (6 months)

Noggin Video Art Installation. Purpose: Developed a real time video art installation incorporating live adaptive video background removal, warping, compositing, video feedback, cellular automata, gestural control, automatic and interactive modes.

Core Game Developer, The Sims at Maxis

January 1997 - March 2000 (3 years 3 months)

Worked on a small, agile programming team with Will Wright, managed by Jim Mackraz, developing The Sims. Delivered an ambitious, high quality product on schedule, top selling PC game of all time, winning critical acclaim and numerous awards.

Designed and implemented The Sims character animation system, content creation tools, visual programming tools, user interface, pie menus, architectural editing tools.

Contributed to user interface and game design, implementation, pie menus, architectural editing tools, dialogs, etc. SimAntics visual programming language gui. SimShow preview tool. Made significant contributions to the game and user interface design, and developed important tools (SimShow, Transmogrifier, RugOMatic) enabling player created content.

Top selling game of all time, shipping over 70 million units worldwide. Won Outstanding Achievement in Game Design, Outstanding Achievement in Game Play Engineering and Game of the Year 2000, 2001 Game of the Year.

Member Technical Staff at Interval Research Corporation

January 1996 - January 1997 (1 year 1 month)

Research programmer. Visual programming languages. Component technology. Signal processing. Graphics. Director. Real time video. Lisp. C++. Win32. ActiveX. MFC. Lots of other secret stuff.

Senior Programmer at Kaleida Labs

November 1993 - January 1996 (2 years 3 months)

Designed and implemented a distributed object messaging system. User interface and graphics programming. Object oriented software architecture. Web programming. Authoring tool programming. Writing white papers and ScriptX coding samples. Web server administration. Developer services. Demonstrating new technologies at conferences and trade shows.

Contractor at Levity

August 1993 - November 1993 (4 months)

Worked with David Levitt on Bounce, an interactive real time visual data flow programming language for the Mac. Bounce was originally called Body Electric, developed by VPL for graphical data flow programming of virtual reality performances, interactive TV shows, dynamic multimedia simulations, etc. It's useful for

real time input device processing, dynamic 3D rendering, and remote control of devices networked via midi, serial, ethernet, etc.

Hacked the ANSI C Bounce language source code, using Think C, as well as programming visual data flow modules in Bounce itself. Worked on the interface to the MacroMedia Director projector, that David had originally developed for his earlier visual programming language "Hookup". Built data flow modules into Bounce for controlling animation, sound, projector info, sprite info, hit detection, window control, monitor volume, etc.

Contractor at DUX Software

October 1991 - November 1993 (2 years 2 months)

Ported SimCity to Unix, licensed SimCity from Maxis. Produced and shipped two products: SimCity HyperLook Edition for NeWS; Multi Player SimCity for X11. Awarded best product of 1992 by Unix World.

Studied and optimized original Macintosh C and assembly source code. Rewrote gui using NeWS and HyperLook on OpenWindows 3.0. Rewrote gui again using TCL/Tk on X11, adding multi player support. Wrote audio server , multiple scrolling map views, shared overlays, fast shared memory animation, optimized bitmap updating, talking pie menus, and many other improvements. Wrote illustrated reference manual. Produced and delivered completed product and manual to DUX, and distributed SimCity via Internet FTP and the Sun Catalyst CDROM.

Ported SimCity to OpenWindows on Sun, X11 on Sun, SGI, HP, DEC, and NCD audio X terminals. Designed and implemented multi-user SimCity for X11, with TCL/Tk scripting language and gui.

Research Programmer at Carnegie Mellon University Computer Science Department

September 1992 - May 1993 (9 months)

Worked for Brad Myers as a research programmer on the Garnet project.

Garnet is an advanced object oriented user interface management system for X11, written in Common Lisp, using KR, a prototype based object oriented frame system with constraints. Redesigned the "Opal" graphics layer of Garnet to be modular and portable, by defining a "Glass" interface (Graphical Layer and Server Simplifier), in order to port Garnet from X11 to Display PostScript and the Mac. Rewrote the Garnet PostScript graphics printing module. See the "Garnet Project Home Page".

Extended the "tvtwm" X11 ICCCM virtual window manager to support user definable pie menus with graphical labels, and designed a set of efficient window management pie menus. The source code is available via anonymous ftp. See the "piewm" source code distribution.

User Interface Programmer at The Turing Institute

February 1992 - September 1992 (8 months)

Worked with Arthur van Hoff in Glasgow, Scotland. Developed HyperLook, an object oriented direct manipulation graphical user interface development environment for NeWS in Open Windows.

Designed and implemented object oriented multimedia toolkit components for animation, video, and audio, using ANSI C, object oriented PostScript, and PdB (a C to PostScript compiler).

Integrated The NeWS Toolkit Open Look components so they can be copied and pasted into the user interface and edited with property sheets. Rewrote the direct manipulation user interface editor as a separate component so it can be easily customized and replaced, and removed to create a runtime system.

Rewrote the client/server communication library to use the NeWS "wire service", making it possible to integrate existing client side NeWS libraries into HyperLook applications.

Wrote an interactive animated cellular automata machine, and several other HyperLook demos. Ported SimCity to HyperLook.

Member Technical Staff at Sun Microsystems

July 1990 - October 1991 (1 year 4 months)

Worked for Rafael Bracho on the NeWS toolkit (TNT), an Open Look user interface toolkit written in object oriented PostScript, for the NeWS window system.

Designed, implemented, tested and documented Open Look GUI components. Worked on all parts of the toolkit, designing application programmer interfaces, implementing and extending user interface components, hacking 2D and 3D Open Look, multiple screens, 24 bit displays, and internationalization.

Participated in TNT design reviews and NeWS architecture group. Helped review, rewrite, and produce illustrations for manuals. Ported HyperNeWS 1.3 to TNT, and worked with the Turing Institute in the redesign of HyperNeWS 2.0.

Designed and implemented many applications, tutorial demos, and utilities, including graphical data structure browsers, ICCCM window managers, pie menus, a thin wire Gnu Emacs driver supporting "drag'n'drop", and pizzatool, which graphically previews your pizza then faxes the order to the pizza parlor.

Research Programmer at University of Maryland Human Computer Interaction Lab

January 1988 - May 1990 (2 years 5 months)

Worked for Ben Shneiderman, in the Human Computer Interaction Lab, researching and implementing user interfaces.

Developed HyperTIES hypermedia browser and authoring tool for NeWS, hypertext markup language interpreter in Forth and C, PostScript graphics and text formatter, animation, gui components, and a multi-window UniPress Emacs based authoring tool.

Developed compelling feedback techniques for "embedded menu" image map highlighting, with interactive PostScript graphics. Streamlined gui with gestural pie menus for quick paging and navigation. Used Mitch Bradley's Sun Forth to write HyperTIES markup language interpreter. Integrated C formatter library into Forth.

Designed and implemented PSIBER Space Deck, a visual user interface to the PostScript programming environment in the NeWS window system.

Produced and video taped user interface demonstrations for use in classes and seminars, and gave many live demos to visitors and at conferences and trade shows.

Software Developer at UniPress Software

June 1988 - August 1988 (3 months)

Worked with Mike Gallaher on the UniPress Emacs NeWS window system interface. Rewrote the multi-window display driver for NeWS. Implemented a popup menu interface, a menu compiler, a text selection interface, tab windows, and pie menus, including custom font and color selection pie menus. Ported the Emacs NeWS interface to the 4Sight window system on the Silicon Graphics Iris 4D.

Research Programmer at University of Maryland Computer Science Department

September 1985 - January 1988 (2 years 5 months)

Ported Z-80 FIG-Forth to the ZMob parallel processor. Xerox workstations, Vax and Sun Unix installation and system administration, networking, systems programming, MILNET contact, ARPANET liaison, X10 and NeWS window system maintenance, international mailing list administration (NeWS-makers).

Promoted to the Heterogeneous Systems Lab, to research window systems and user interfaces for the late Mark Weiser. Designed, implemented, and evaluated pie menus, as an extension to the X10 "uwm" window manager. Integrated Mitch Bradley's 68000 Sun Forth with the pie menu "uwm" window manager.

Worked with Jack Callahan, Ben Shneiderman and Mark Weiser, to implement and carry out a human factors experiment comparing pie menus and linear menus. Integrated the X10 "uwm" window manager with Mitch Bradley's 68000 Sun Forth, and programmed it to carry out the experiment and record the results. The experiment showed that pie menus were faster and more reliable than linear menus.

Summer Intern at Sun Microsystems

June 1987 - August 1987 (3 months)

Worked as a summer intern for Forth Guru Mitch Bradley (the developer of the OpenFirmware Forth boot ROMs used by the OLPC, Mac, Sun, etc).

Extended the CADroid schematic board design CAD system with CForth, and implemented a higher level, user friendly, "programming by demonstration" scripting interface. Integrated a Forth system written in C into the CADroid code, exposed the application's functions to Forth, and designed and implemented a command processor in Forth that executes, records and replays CADroid commands.

Added higher level control statements, loops, conditionals, variables, expressions, macros, argument prompting, and a mouse interface. Supported user friendly syntax, helpful prompting for arguments, macro programming by demonstration, and interactive loops and conditionals.

Projects

HyperNews and HyperLook
1990 to 1993
Members:Don Hopkins, Arthur van Hoff, Doug Scoular

Skills & Expertise

Python
User Interface
XML
Game Development
Java
User Experience
Data Visualization
c#
Unity3D
TurboGears
SQLAlchemy
iPhone
iOS development
Server Administration
Linux
Amazon Web Services (AWS)
Lisp
Emacs
OpenLaszlo
Open Source
Game Design
Visual Programming
Video
Programming

Software Development
OOP
Unix
Web Development
JavaScript
MySQL
Distributed Systems
C#
REST
PHP
AJAX
Mobile Devices
Web Services

Education

University of Maryland College Park

BS, Computer Science, 1984 - 1990

Activities and Societies: Computer Science Department system staff. Parallal Processing Lab system programmer. Heterogeneous Systems Lab research programmer. Human Computer Interaction Lab research programmer.

Interests

Unity3D,

C#,

Python,

pie menus,

cellular automata,

user interface design and architecture,

programming languages,

visual programming,

scripting and software integration,

distributed computing,

computer game design.

Languages

English

Don Hopkins

Chief Architect at Pantomime Corporation

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11 people have recommended Don

"Don is nothing short of brilliant. He's an eccentric super-genius motivated by technology. If God was a programmer, he'd be humbled by Don. ... I'm not being sarcastic, either!"

— Cari Davidson, worked with Don at TomTom

"Don has been a freind for years, and became a client in 2007. Don is hard working, brilliant, and more fun to be around than just about any other living person."

— Liz Zitzow, worked with Don at TomTom

"Don is unbelievable, a gifted visionary, bounding with ideas and energy, I learnt much from and hope to work with him agin."

— Robert Raucher, was with another company when working with Don at ConnectedMedia

"Don is an energetic genius who not only helped to create the #1 computer game of all time, "The Sims," but was also instrumental in the growth of "The Sims" internet community. Without his creation of The Sims Transmogrifier, the online popularity of The Sims may never have reached it's peak. His dedication, continuation of support and upgrades allowed people to make user created content (CC) with more speed and quality."

— Heather Castillo, worked directly with Don at Electronic Arts

"Don Is a professional and resourceful software engineer who has a expert grasp on his field! He would be a great person to have on your project."

— Mark Bartlett, was Don's client

"Don Hopkins is a good friend and simply a genius with a creative mind that is rare and precious to find and meet those days. His contribution to the future development of FOSS and noble idea of delivering Micropolis (SimCity) to OLPC is marvelous achievement that made me happy to see how bright the future can be created by an individual. His educational and creative expertise inspired me and lots of other people many times and many-fold. I guess I am just really lucky to know such rare and creative person. It has been always an honor

to meet and cooperate with Don in present, as well as to continue in the future. He is one of very few people I would like to have on board and work with if possibility permits, but also great person to socialize and have fun."

— Harv Stanic, worked with Don at Maxis

"Don really put in the hours and was a jack-of-all-trades on the small Sims 1.0 team. Among many other things, he reworked the behavior editing front end for production and wrote the 3D animation system and 3DSMax exporter."

— Jamie Doornbos, worked directly with Don at Maxis

"Don is the coolest guy ever. When you see those Sims dance, thank god for Don. Oh, and the demo he did at Siggraph decades ago on radial menus is my best Siggraph memory ever!"

— Grant BlahaErath, worked with Don at Maxis

"Actually, I think Don may have been a student when I was at Sun. Don's pie menus were the simplest, yet most amazing and useful piece of technology ever inspired by PostScript. Combine such simple innovation with Don's enthusiasm and joy, and what you get is the most delightful of engineers to work with. If I were at liberty to move to Amsterdam, Don could recruit me any old time."

— Robin Schaufler, was with another company when working with Don at Interval Research Corporation

"Don could be counted on to come up with really interesting uses of ScriptX that demonstrated it's flexibility. He is a fun guy to work with."

— Andrew Nicholson, worked with Don at Kaleida Labs

"Don's software development and testing methodology is nothing short of performance art. I literally put him on stage in front of most of the user interface designers in the world in 1990, doing nothing more than his own standard demo of a visualization of the entire Internet. Having seen since then his development methodology firsthand, I realized that he can handle as many as three workstations in play at once, one merely as inspiration. I have met no person who so understands software as an art. It surprises me not at all that he went on to work on some of the world's most successful non-violent games. He's a peaceful and powerful soul."

— Craig Hubley, managed Don at University of Maryland Human Computer Interaction Lab

Contact Don on LinkedIn